

World Day for Safety and Health at Work

28.04.2021.

The Safety at Work Association of Montenegro (SWAM), in co-organization and with the support of the ILO and the Ministry of Economic Development, marked the World Occupational Safety and Health Day with a conference.

The emphasis of this conference was on protection and health at work in construction, which is one of the largest, but also the most risky industries for the life and health of employees, both globally and in Montenegro. Employees in the construction sector are exposed to a high risk of injuries at work, especially severe as well as fatal ones, especially in cases when workers who are not trained for safe work or have not passed a previous health check are hired. This situation is worrying, as one of the criteria for closing Chapter 19 is the implementation of the Law on Occupational Safety and Health, which has been harmonized with the relevant EU Directives with a special emphasis on the construction sector. In this regard, the Association of Occupational Safety of Montenegro, in the previous period, implemented a number of activities focused on the construction sector, within the project "Build knowledge - protect yourself" which is supported and funded by the Ministry of Economic Development.

On the occasion of the World Day for Safety and Health at Work, the association presented 6 awards for three legal entities and three individuals, who gave the greatest contribution in this area in the construction sector in the previous year, and the goal was to draw attention to some good practices, which will be an incentive and example to others.

The winners of the awards are in the category of legal entities: "Ramel", "Čelebić" and "CEDIS", and in the category of natural persons: environmental engineer Jovan Radenović, journalist "Vijesti" Goran Kapor and graduate engineer of shipbuilding Marjan Brčić.

ILO presented a very important document - the National Profile of Occupational Safety and Health in Montenegro, prepared by Prof. Dr. Petar Bulat. The profile provides numerous information in the field of occupational health and safety, which relate to a large number of injuries at work, high mortality, lack of records of injuries and occupational diseases, lack of the Institute of Occupational Medicine, lack of National Council for Occupational Health and Safety, underrepresentation of occupational safety and health in the educational system of Montenegro - problems that the Association of Occupational Safety of Montenegro has been pointing out for many years.

SWAM expects that, after the presentation of this important document, the competent public institutions will give higher priority to solving these problems, which will contribute to better implementation of the Law on Occupational Safety and Health, and thus improve working conditions, reduce injuries and occupational diseases.

























